

לכבוד the ברית coming up of our new member of our family, a הייליגא כהן. In פרשת שמות, baby משה is sent down the river Nile in a basket and פרעה's daughter finds him. She looks at him and she says, "This is a very cute kid, I want to keep him". She decides to allow him to live.

רש"י tells us that she went from one nursing mother to another and baby משה'לע refused to drink. Why? רש"י says because the mouth that is destined to speak with the שכינה should not be drinking milk from a goyish, טמא person.

The Vilna Gaon explains that this is the source of the הלכה stated by the רמ"א that the milk of an Egyptian wet nurse is exactly like the milk of a Jew, it's כשר. However, if a person can possibly get a Jewish nursing woman to feed the baby, one should not take the Egyptian mother, should rather use the Jewish mother. Why? Because the milk of an זרה עובד has a negative effect on a baby, so we could try as hard as we can not to do that.

R' Yaakov Kamenetsky asks a שטארקע קשיא: How is it possible to say that a Jewish child should not drink from non-Jewish milk? The whole story is learned from משה רבינו, and in *his* case, he was not allowed to drink from a goyish woman because he was going to speak to the שכינה. How does that apply to the rest of us?

R' Yaakov answers: We learn from this a tremendous lesson in how we raise our children. Every kid has the potential to speak to the שכינה. That's how every parent should look at his child. "I want my child to fulfill his maximum potential, which is what? To go all the way up to the level of משה רבינו and speak to the שכינה." They should continue to raise him and treat him in exactly the same way as משה רבינו was treated, because he is their potential משה, each and every Jewish child is a potential משה.

